

HISTORY SCHEME OF WORK JSS TWO
THIRD TERM

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Week 2

DIFFERENCES IN CULTURE AND CUSTOMS OF DIFFERENT CENTRE'S OF CIVILIZATION

Meaning of culture and customs

Culture can be defined as all the ways of life including arts, beliefs and institutions of a population that are passed down from generation to generation. Culture has been called the way of life for an entire society. Custom is defined as a cultural idea that describes a regular, patterned behavior that is considered characteristic of life in a social system. Shaking hands, bowing, and kissing—all customs—are methods of greeting people. The method most commonly used in a given society helps distinguish one culture from another.

Such differences were very clear in the following areas:

1. **Language:** the language of virtually all the Centre's were different. In Hausa states, Hausa language was the dominant language while in the place like Oyo empire and Ife, Yoruba language was dominant. The Niger Delta City-states like Urhobo, Anaang, Ibibio and so on had their different languages. The Igbo also had common language called Igbo though not without slight differenced but they could still understand themselves.
2. **Dressing:** Each Centre had different ways of dressing. This was applicable to the ruler's regalia. The regalia of an Oba of Benin was different from that of Etsu of Nupe. The same applied to Alaafin of Oyo empire in Yorubaland and Obong of Calabar in the Niger Delta.

Furthermore, the dressing of Yoruba men and women was different from that of men and women from Hausa states.

3. **Songs:** each Centre had peculiar songs and music for different occasions like installation of kings/rulers, naming, marriage and burial ceremonies etc.
4. **Musical instruments:** Centre's of civilization in Nigeria had different musical instruments for different occasions. The musical instruments in the Hausa states included Kakaki, Goje, and so on. The Oyo Empire also had musical instruments like, iya ilu, omele, dundu etc. The Igbo had it's local instruments such as Udu, Ogene, Ekwe, ec.

Each of them had different musical instruments for different ceremonies like naming, burial and marriage ceremonies.

5. **Food:** Hausa states had food such as tuwo shinkafa with suitable soup.
The Calabar in Niger Delta had Edikang- Ikong soup, Afang soup etc. Garri, fufu and other swallows. The Igbo had Okra soup, Uha soup, Ogbono soup and so on.
6. **Arts:** the Centre's had different art works which stood out among other cultures. Igbo ukwu artifacts were peculiar to the Igbos, the bronze works such ad Ife and Obalufon heads were among artifacts distinguishing Ife arts. The bronze and brass works of arts of the Benin Empire were among the best artifacts in many museums in the world. There was also Nok artifacts from centers in the central Nigeria. These were just a few among different works of art among these Centre's of civilization.

7. **Dancing:** Each Centre had different dancing steps. These were always dictated by drums, songs and the type of ceremony taking place.
8. **Adornment:** the Centre's of civilization in the pre-colonial days had peculiar ways of adorning themselves. The use of beads was very common among the people from Benin Empire, Urhobo l, Itsekiri etc. The use of Lalli for painting and drawings on the body was common among the Hausa and Fulani societies while Osun was another painting material used among the Yoruba. The Nupe also used bracelets as part of their dressing.
9. **Greetings:** each Centre had ways of greeting themselves. In Old Oyo Empire, the subjects used to prostrate for their king and when the younger men were greeting their elders. In Hausa states men would bend low to greet facing each other, shaking hands and touching chest particularly people of the same age. Among the Igbo, greeting was by handshake or Boeing down.

Evaluation

1. Describe the mode of greetings among the Hausas.
2. What is culture?
3. Describe the musical instruments in Pre-colonial Nigeria.
4. Kakaaki was a major instrument in which area?
5. What did the Itsekiris use as part of their dressing?
6. Describe the different artworks of different Centre's of civilization in pre-colonial Nigeria.
7. List different food peculiar to different Centre's of civilization in pre-Colonial Nigeria.
8. What do you understand by custom.
9. Describe the adornment peculiar to different Centre's of civilization in pre-colonial Nigeria
10. What is the difference between culture and custom?

Week 3

GHANA EMPIRE: EARLY HISTORY OF GHANA EMPIRE

The empire's name, Ghana, originated as a title meaning 'war chief' among the Soninke rulers, and over time it was extended to denote the entire state. The Ghana Empire, also known as Wagadou, was founded by the Soninke people, and was based in the city of Kumbi Saleh. This title later became the name of the state or empire in the 8th century A.D. (a large area that was conquered by the king of Aoukar Kingdom).

Ghana was one of the earliest known Negro empires recorded by Historians. It was first mentioned in the book "Al-Masudi" by an Arab geographer Al-Fazari in 773 A.D. as the 'land of gold'. Later in the 11th century A.D, an Arab traveler named AL-Bakri also mentioned it in his writing in 1067 A.D. Kumbi Saleh, widely recognized as the capital, lay on the expansive grasslands near the Senegal and Niger rivers—a strategic location that fostered the lucrative trans-Saharan trade.

By 1000 A.D. the Soninke kingdom expanded to the west of River Senegal and to the southern part of the Western Sudanese town of Audoghost in the Sahara Desert and controlled most of the territories of the modern states of Senegal, Mali and Guinea. It covered roughly about 650,000 square kilometres. This made her to be in control of the Western Trans-Saharan Trade route.

Map of Ghana at its peak.



FACTORS THAT LEAD TO THE RISE OF GHANA EMPIRE

The following factors were responsible for the rise and growth of the Ghana Empire.

1. **Its geographical position:** The area around Ghana was very fertile to grow sufficient food for consumption and inter-state trade. The position of the empire at the terminus of Trans-Saharan trade route was part of the favorable geographical conditions. This enhances the growth of trade with the Berber merchants of North Africa.
2. **Trade:** The Empire derived a great wealth from trade, the chief articles of which were gold and salt. Ghana was known as the richest empire in the Western

Sudan for gold. The caravan merchants brought salt for exchange with Ghana exports. As a result, Kumbi Saleh and Walata and Audaghast emerged as important commercial centres.

3. **Expansionist policy of the kings:** With the expansion of the empire northwards, and the subsequent capture of Audaghast, Ghana was able to control the southern part of the Western trans-Saharan trade routes and the gold mines at Wangara and the salt mines at Tagant. The king had monopoly of the gold trade which brought him great wealth. He also imposed levy on the goods that came in or went out of the empire.

4. **Standing large army:** The large army of the empire also contributed greatly to its growth. The army were equipped with sword and lances to attack their neighbors who were using wood (bars of ebony). With a superior army, Ghana continued to expand its territories and conquered important trading cities

5. **Good government:** The good government established by its leaders contributed to its growth and rise. There was a strong central administration that coordinated the provincial administrations. There was sufficient revenue to run the government.

Evaluation

1. What does the word "Ghana" mean?
2. What was the capital of Ghana empire?
3. Narrate the history of Ghana Empire.
4. Ghana empire covers about _____ square kilometers.
5. Ghana empire was situated on the grassland north of which rivers?
6. Ghana Empire can be found in which part of Africa?
7. What system of government was practiced in Ghana Empire?
8. What was the impact of the army on the growth of Ghana Empire?
9. List two factors that led to the rise of Ghana Empire.
10. Describe the trading activities of Ghana Empire.

Week 4

THE SOCIO-POLITICAL STRUCTURE OF GHANA EMPIRE

A description of how Ghana was organized and governed involves primarily a description of the government at the Centre, the provinces and the vassal states, as well as the organization of the trade and the army of Ghana.

The Emperor or King was the head of the executive, legislative and judicial system of the empire. He had divine rights and his arrival to public gathering was announced by the beating of a special drum. The king resides at the capital city, Kumbi Saleh with the indigenous population in one section while the immigrant Muslim population lived in the other section of the city.

The King was helped by the Council of Advisers or Ministers. The chief councilor acted as the Prime Minister. From the 11th century, when Islam was introduced, the king chose some of his advisers from among the Muslim scholars because of their education and experience. There were courts of various grades in the empire, and appeals from lower courts finally went to the emperor who sat with a number of judges.

The systems of government in the provinces and in the vassal, states were accountable to the emperor. Powers were delegated to the provincial governors and were allowed some measure of independence in the day-to-day administration of the provinces so long as they made regular remittances to the Centre. In many cases, the chief of the conquered people were left as vassal to the conqueror. This ensured co-operation of vassal states with the Centre. The great measure of decentralization of authority was a suitable system in an age when the means of communication and transport were slow and inadequate. This ensured peace and order throughout the empire.

Below the provincial and vassal states rulers were the district chiefs who enjoyed some degree of autonomy in their areas of control. While rulers of the provinces paid tributes to the king as well as contribute their warriors to the central army when they are required to do so. This also makes the king to protect them against external attacks.

Trade was another relevant part of the socio-political structure of the empire. There was a good tariff system as well as a royal monopoly of gold trade. There were two types of tariffs: the export and import duties and the tax on production.

The army was strong and backed up the economic arrangements in the empire. The army was large and well equipped with iron weapons while their neighbors fought with bars of ebony. The principal unit of the army was based in Kumbi Saleh the capital. Provinces and vassal states sent peasant soldiers to the Centre during the time of wars. Provincial governors were not only political leaders but also military leaders.

FACTORS THAT LED TO THE FALL OF GHANA EMPIRE

The decline and fall of the Ghana Empire were caused by internal and external factors.

INTERNAL FACTORS

1. **Lack of adequate means of communication:** The size of the empire made it difficult for the central government to send quick messages to the remote parts of the empire and establish a high degree of central control. This made the achievement of unity and suppression of revolts in remote parts very difficult.
2. **Lack of well-defined system of succession:** The lack of well-defined and firmly established system of Succession to the throne provided opportunity for court intrigues and succession disputes which often led to civil wars.
3. **Lack of natural barriers:** The lack of natural frontiers like big rivers or mountains ranges to make foreign attacks difficult or impossible made Ghana vulnerable to her neighbors. Constant attacks from her neighbors weaken her army.
4. **Availability of Gold:** Gold which led to the growth of the empire also contributed to its decline. The availability of gold in Ghana attracted series of foreign invaders who plundered her in order to take her wealth. Mossi from the south and the Berbers from the north attacked Ghana for economic reasons.

EXTERNAL FACTORS

1. **The Almoravid invasion:** The Sanhaja Berbers of the north whose capital city-Audaghost, Ghana captured led to increasing attacks from the Berbers to recapture their city. By 1076 A.D. the Sanhaja under the leadership of Abu Bakri captured Kumbi Saleh under the guise of spreading Islam but rather, the real purpose was to plunder the gold of Ghana. Ghana regained her independence in 1087 A.D. but did not recover completely from the stroke.
2. **Revolts:** The consequence of the Almoravid attacks gave some smaller kingdoms the effrontery to revolts and secede from the empire. The vassal states of Diarra, Tekrur and Kanaiga emerged as semi-independent kingdoms. This had a devastating effect on the empire and loss of sources of wealth.
3. **The foreign attacks continued with Sumanguru** who defeated Ghana and seize the capital, Kumbi Saleh in 1203 A.D. He taxed the inhabitants so heavily that a great number of the population moved to Walata and other cities in the Western Sudan. Thus, Sumanguru contributed to the fall of Ghana Empire.
4. **The last straw that broke the camel's back** was the attack on Ghana by Sundiata, the young ruler of Mali. Sundiata conquered Sumanguru and declared Mali which was a former vassal of Ghana an Independent state. This invasion marked the end of Ghana Empire.

THE CONSEQUENCES OF THE FALL OF GHANA EMPIRE

1. **The fall of Kumbi Saleh** forced the Soninke people to scatter westwards and southwards to the Volta area. The immigrants were regarded as the ancestors of the modern Ghana.
2. **The collapse of Ghana Empire** produced a power vacuum in the Western Sudan which made other states to struggle to fill it causing a lot of wars and displacement until Mali Empire rose to the occasion.

3. It caused a shift east ward in the use of the trans-Saharan trade routes. Timbuktu emerged as the new most important 'entrepot' for trade from the North Africa and trade route from Morocco to Timbuktu became the most important than others.

Evaluation

1. The head of the executive, legislative and Judicial system in Ghana Empire was?
2. Ghana empire fell in which year?
3. When was Islam introduced into Ghana Empire?
4. Which invasion of Kumbi Saleh led to the fall of Ghana Empire.
5. List two consequences of the fall of Ghana Empire.
6. List two internal factors that led to the fall of Ghana Empire.
7. List two external factors that led to the fall of Ghana Empire.
8. Describe the socio political structure of Ghana Empire.
9. List three factors that led to the rise of Ghana Empire.
10. Which empire rose to replace Ghana Empire

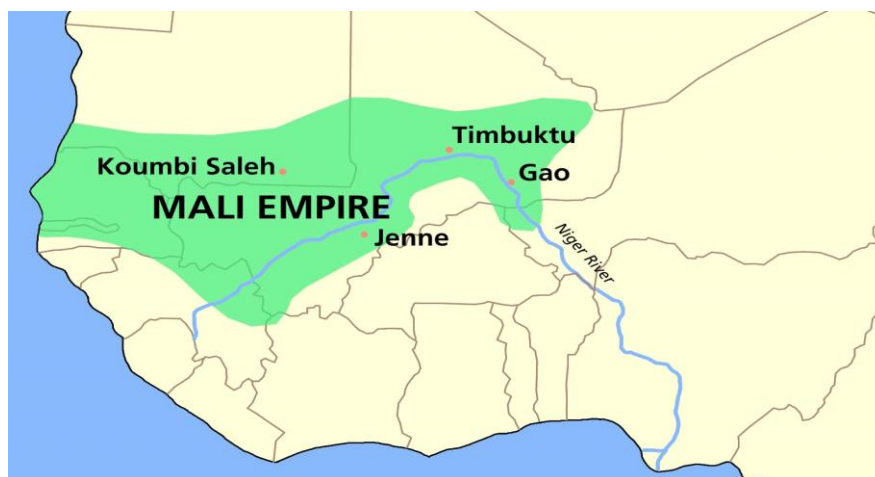
Week 5

MALI EMPIRE

EARLY HISTORY OF MALI EMPIRE

Sundiata Keita, after the defeat of Sumanguru laid the foundation of Mali Empire, in West Africa and took the title of Mansa. Before the conquest of Sumanguru in 1240 A.D., Sundiata the King of Kangaba, united the small villages of the Malinke Kingdom which has its capital at Dugutigi together to present a united front against external aggressors and to also participate in the flourish Trans-Saharan trade. He conquered Susu, Chieftain of Kaniaga in 1235 A.D. He moved the capital of Kangaba from Jeriba to Niani. Having united his conquests under a central authority, he continued to pursue expansionist policy and established a standing army which he used to conquer many other kingdoms.

While early Mali featured a blend of traditional African beliefs and emerging Islamic influences, Islam eventually became the dominant faith under rulers such as Mansa Musa.



FACTORS FOR THE RISE OF MALI EMPIRE

1. **Standing army:** The establishment of a standing army by Sundiata played a key role in the rise and growth of Mali Empire. Prior to the rise of Sundiata, peasants were used to fight whenever there was war. When he became the ruler, he organized the army and used them to conquer the neighboring principalities like Susu in 1235 A.D., Kaniaga in 1237 A.D. and Sumanguru IN 1240 A.D. at the battle of Krina.
2. **Geographical location:** The geographical position of the empire at the southern terminus of the western Trans-Saharan trade routes favored the growth of trade which in turn contributed immensely to the growth of the empire. Also, its positions in the Guinea Savannah lands of the Western Sudan allowed the people to practice agriculture and produced enough food to feed a large population including its standing army.
3. **Good political environment:** The political situation in the area at that time when Sundiata became king in Kangaba was full of hostility and tyrannical. The association of a number of small villages which became the state of

Kangaba saw Sundiata as a liberator. So they gave him all the support he needed to defeat Sumanguru lordship.

4. **Islamic Religion homogeneity:** The Islamic religion had entered the area around the 11th century A.D. unlike Ghana Empire that was a mixture. This gave them unity and easy mobilization for a union.
5. **Expansionist policies of the successors of Sundiata:** Mansa Uli who succeeded Sundiata in 1255 A.D. continued the expansionist policy. Mansa Musa who became the emperor in 1312 continued this policy and advanced the growth of the empire. More so, the pilgrimage he made to Mecca in 1324 A.D. announced the empire to the outside world. The empire expanded to the Atlantic coast in the west, beyond Gao in the northeast and beyond Walata and Timbuktu in the North. Timbuktu was an important city in Mali. It had a famous university with a large library containing Greek and Roman books.

Evaluation

1. Who was the head of the legislative in Mali Empire?
2. What was the main religion in the empire of Mali from the onset?
3. What was the role of Sundiata Keita in the growth of Mali Empire?
4. Where was the Empire of Mali located in Africa?
5. Timbuktu was _____
6. Which city had a famous university with a large library?
7. Narrate the early history of Mali empire
8. List three rulers of Mali Empire.
9. Who was the founder of Mali Empire?
10. Who was the richest black man in history?

WEEK 7

THE SOCIO-POLITICAL STRUCTURE OF MALI EMPIRE

The system of government in Mali was same as the system of government in Ghana Empire, which is described as the king being the head of the executive, legislative and the judiciary.

The emperor was the head of the legislative council in Mali. Before Islam was introduced in the 9th century, the emperor was divine. He rarely appears in public. Hence, he did not sit in the legislative council which met frequently at the palace to make laws. The decision of the council was always conveyed to the king by the Chief Minister before the king gave approvals.

The executive council was headed by the king. The Council Of Ministers met regularly with the king to advise the Emperor and were responsible for the administration of the capital town, Niani. They also supervised the provincial governors and the vassal kings.

In the judicial administration, the king was also the head. There were lower courts in the provinces and vassal states where cases were looked into by the local kings. When there was an appeal, the King presided at the King's court. He also presided over serious cases like murder, treason and arson.

The army also played the great role of defense and protection of the entire empire and the maintenance of law and order. The military was strong and large enough by the standard of the time to back up the political and economic arrangements described above.

The economic prospered due to the provision of law and order. Trade boomed and was well organized. Tariff system and royal monopoly of gold mines in the empire in order to regulate the supply of gold and enhance its value. The subjects paid import and export taxes and production tax as well.

FACTORS THAT LED TO THE FALL OF MALI EMPIRE

Just like Ghana Empire, the factors responsible for the decline and fall of Mali Empire were also internal and external.

INTERNAL FACTORS

1. **Over expansion of the empire:** Due to the expansionist policy carried out by the Mansas, the empire became too large in size. The army could not control the rebellion and the secessionist actions of some of the vassal states.
2. **Succession of weak rulers:** The ascension of some weak rulers to the office of the king after Mansa Sulayman became a challenge to the empire. Dynastic disputes among the royal caused a deep crack in the empire.
3. **Inadequate communication:** The Empire became too large and communication to the nook and cranny of the empire became difficult. The size of the empire made it difficult for the central government to send quick messages to the remote parts of the empire and establish a high degree of central control. This made the achievement of unity and suppression of revolts in remote parts very difficult.

EXTERNAL FACTORS

1. **Constant attack by the enemies:** The weakness of the later kings made it possible for the vassals to secede and began to assault the frontiers of the empire from all directions. The led by Akil, attacked and captured Walata and Timbuktu in 1433 A.D., the two most important trading cities in the empire.

2. **Revolt and Secession:** The escape of the two sons of the king of Gao, Ali Kolen and Nar, whom Mansa Musa has kept as hostages escaped from the Mali court and succeeded in making their way back home. They raised a Songhai army against the Mandingo soldiers who Mansa Musa had stationed in Songhai territory and expelled them and declared Gao an independent state and replaced Mali in fame, influence and power. Ali Kolen was proclaimed King of Songhai. The influence of Mali ended when Sunni Ali became the King of Songhai, he overrun Mali altogether.

Evaluation

1. State the factors that led to the fall of Mali Empire
2. Who was the head of executive on Mali empire
3. The founder and first king of Mali Empire was?
4. Provinces in Mali were governed by?
5. What was the most important mosque of the empire?
6. Which ruler brought about the end of Mali Empire?
7. Describe the judicial system in Mali Empire.
8. Which two important cities were in Mali?
9. What role did the army play in Mali Empire?
10. Describe the legislative council in Mali Empire.

Week 8

SONGHAI EMPIRE

EARLY HISTORY OF SONGHAI EMPIRE

The Songhai Empire was a powerful West African civilization from about 1450-1600. At its height, in the fifteenth and sixteenth centuries, the Songhai Empire was the largest empire in West Africa.

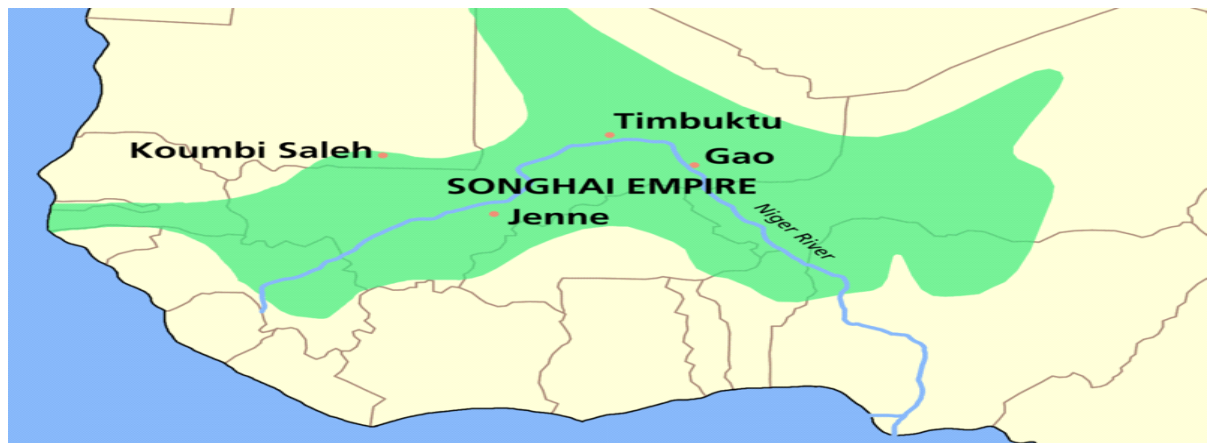
Replacing Mali as the most important empire in West Africa, The kingdom grew after the decline of the Mali Empire. The Songhai people broke away from Mali control after Mansa Musa's death.

The Songhai Empire first came into power under the leadership of Sunni Ali. Sunni Ali was a prince of the Songhai. He was being held as a political prisoner by the leader of the Mali Empire who ruled over the Songhai. In 1464, Sunni Ali escaped to the city of Gao and took control of the city. From the city of Gao, he established the Songhai Empire and began to conquer nearby regions including the important trading cities of Timbuktu and Djenne.

The Songhai cultures

The Songhai culture became a blend of traditional West African beliefs and the religion of Islam. Daily life was often ruled by traditions and local customs, but the law of the land was based on Islam.

If a prisoner of war had already converted to Islam before being captured, they could not be sold as a slave.



Map of Songhai at its zenith.

FACTORS FOR THE RISE OF SONGHAI EMPIRE

1. **Geographical location:** The location of Gao in the Trans-Saharan Trade routes gave Songhai advantages over Mali Empire. Through Saharan trade, the growth of Songhai grew faster and faster. Songhai was situated in the Savannah region and also along the most fertile basin of the Niger River. These endowed Songhai with abundant food crops, fish and cattle which provided for large population.

The river Niger provided navigable way and easy mobility for communication during time of peace and war.

2. **Strong rulers:** Songhai was blessed with strong rulers like Sunni Ali (1464-1492), Askia Muhammad (1493-1528), and Askia Ishak (1543-1549). Sunni Ali laid the foundation and Askia Muhammad consolidated the empire through conquests and expansion of the frontiers of Songhai.

Sunni Ali took power in 1464 and became the first king of the Songhai Empire. He further expanded the empire and conquered Timbuktu and Djenné, two important centers for trade and learning

3. **Military prowess:** Sunni Ali introduced conscription into the army and conquered many neighbors. Askia, the Great propelled the empire to its greater heights. Askia established a standing army and built efficient central administration.

Sunni Ali ruled for 30 years, during which time his cities grew and were fortified. Askia Muhammad was a leading general under Sunni Ali. When the ruler died in 1492, Askia Muhammad challenged Sunni Ali's son Sunni Baru for the throne. Askia Muhammad professed that Sunni Baru was not a faithful Muslim and defeated him at the Battle of Anfao.

This established the Askia dynasty of the Songhai Empire. Askia Muhammad became known as Askia the Great, and ruled the kingdom for 37 years.

4. **Religion:** Religion played a great role in the rise of Songhai Empire. Islam was the state religion. And this served as instrument of unity for the people despite the divergent cultures. The pilgrimages made by Askia Muhammad in 1495 A.D., announced Songhai to the world like that of Mansa Musa of Mali. Muslim judges called qadis, ran his legal system on Muslim principles. Most of the people living in cities embraced Islam. In rural areas where most Songhai people lived, however, traditional African religions dominated.

5. **Economic:** The geographical positions of Gao, Timbuktu and Jenne in Songhai Empire helped the empire to flourish and grow. The southern termini of the Trans-Saharan trade route passed through her to North Africa. Due to the role these cities played in the commercial life of the empire, the rulers were able to derive and boost wealth in order to maintain the elaborate machinery of administration and its large army.

Askia the Great also improved the empire's tax system to be more efficient and selected skilled officials to run his central government.

Evaluation

1. Who was the first ruler of Songhai empire?
2. Where Was the Songhai Empire Located?
3. What was Songhai's Timeframe?
4. Which empire did Songhai Empire replace?
5. Which city was first taken over by the Songhai people?

6. List three factors that led to the rise of Songhai empire.
7. Briefly describe the culture of Songhai empire
8. What century did the Songhai empire reach its height?
9. Which areas did the Songhai Empire reach?
10. What was one of the main capital city of Songhai?

Week 9

THE SOCIO-POLITICAL STRUCTURE OF SONGHAI EMPIRE

The socio-political structure of the Songhai Empire was not totally different from that of the empires of Ghana and Mali.

1. **The King:** The king was the head of the central administration in which he was assisted by the council of ministers. Each minister was in charge of a department of state. The most notable ministers were the ones in charge of Finance, Justice, Immigration, and Defense. Others were the Chief of Naval Staff, Minister of Rivers, Lakes and Fisheries and lastly, the Minister of Property matters. Gao was the administrative capital.

2. **Provincial or Regional Administrators:** The Empire was divided into four sub-regions: Karmina, Bala, Bangu and Dendi. A regional Governor was appointed to rule the regions from the Askia family. Local rulers known as Kois exacted some level of authority under close supervision by the Governors.

3. **Sharia administration of Justice:** The Empire was an Islamic empire therefore was administered under the Sharia laws. All judicial officials were under the Chief Justice called Barey Koi.

4. **The Military:** The military were in charge of defence of the empire, quell internal revolts and conquest of new territory. The system of recruitment from conscription was abolished and standing army was raised.

5. **Education:** Islamic education played a great role in the achievement of the empire goals. Large Koranic schools were built in great cities which attracted great minds to the empire. Sankore University, the first of the Universities in Western Sudan was established for Islamic scholarship.

THE FACTORS THE LED TO THE FALL OF SONGHAI EMPIRE

INTERNAL

1. **Poor communication:** The Empire during the reign of Askia Muhammad stretched to the north into Algeria, to the east to include some Hausa states. It became difficult to communicate effectively these wide range of areas. Most of the towns and cities were isolated. Also no natural barriers to prevent external invasion expose the empire to frequent attacks. Hence, it was easy for the Moroccans to move in at the slightest provocation.

2. **The Heterogeneous population:** Ethnic diversity and a number of hostile ethnic groups were in the empire. Moreover, the varying degree of civilization and divergent religious beliefs and the dichotomy between the rich and the poor combined to make it difficult for the empire to have a great degree of unity. All these provided a great opportunity for the Mossi, Fulani and the Berber to attack some parts of the empire and greatly contributed to her decline.

3. **Internal Revolt:** The bad effects of all the various sources of weakness of the empire increased after 1528 when the central authority became ineffective. This precipitated a rebellion by the eldest son and his brother against their father Askia who was over throne and addicted the throne.

4. Rivalry between the Muslims and the Pagan groups: Askia the Great took counsel from the Muslim scholars during his reign. These made them to be privileged and favoured class. At the death of Askia, they became victimized and therefore, formed opposition against the government. This opposition continued until the Moroccan invasion.

EXTERNAL

5. External Revolts: Lack of good leadership, ineffective central administration and the revolts by vassal states lead to the weakness of the empire the more. For example, the most decisive revolt took place in Hausa state of Katsina and this weakened the military power of Songhai.

6. The Moroccan Invasion: The immediate and fundamental cause of the collapse of the empire was the attack from Moroccan army in 1591 A.D. The Sultan of Morocco took advantage of the weakness of the empire and seize the salt mines at Taghaza in 1585 A.D. When information reached Songhai of the march of the Moorish army across the desert towards Songhai, Askia Issiak (Ishak) II summoned a council of war meeting but the council could not take a quick decision on what to do, which was necessary at that point in time. The messengers that were sent to fill up the wells in the northern part of the empire did not do so in time. This decision saved the Moors from dying of thirst.

Moreover, the Moors were well equipped with modern fire arms against the Songhai army who were unable to make use of firearms. The Moors captured Gao and the King opened negotiation with Judar Pasha, Moroccan commander. He offered to give the Moroccans about 12,500 ounces of gold and a thousand slaves, if they would leave for Morocco. He further conceded the control of the Trans-Saharan trade to Morocco. Judar sent messengers to King El Mansur of Morocco to place the terms since he Pasha does not have the power to accept. On the interim, Askia Ishak II, lured the leader of the Moroccan soldiers, Judar Pasha to move his soldiers to Timbuktu with a peace negotiation of offering to provide the Moroccans with horses for transport to Timbuktu from Gao. The people in Timbuktu did not welcome this decision and therefore received the army poorly. When Judar Pasha got to Timbuktu, he pulled down the buildings in a quarter of Timbuktu to make a camp for his soldiers. When the messengers got to Morocco and presented the negotiation terms, the Sultan refused and appointed his trusted friend, Mahmud Pasha, to supersede Judar in the Sudan. Mahmud came to Sudan with reinforcement and took over the command of the Moroccan force from Judar Pasha. King Ishak II was unhappy with the situation. He, therefore, reorganized his army and engaged the Mahmud Pasha command, but he was defeated in Bamba and then forced to cross the Niger River taking his army to Gurma. It was in Gurma that Ishak II was murder by the wandering Tuareg. Thus, the end of Songhai Empire.

Evaluation

1. The Songhai Empire reached the height of its power during which centuries?
2. List three rulers that ruled Songhai empire.
3. Who was the first ruler of Songhai empire.

4. List three factors that led to the rise of Songhai empire
5. What was the name of the university established under the Songhai empire?
6. List four province the Songhai empire was divided into?
7. What was the title of the chief justice?
8. What's the name of the administrative capital?
9. Mention four major bodies in the political structure of Songhai empire.
10. State functions of each of the bodies.